

“IF MUCH OF ENGLISH WRITING TODAY ESPECIALLY BY MEN APPEARS WITHOUT SUBSTANCE, IT IS MAINLY BECAUSE WRITERS LIVE IN BIG TOWNS AND HAVE LITTLE CONTACT WITH REALITIES OF LIFE ON THE LAND.”

Man of the world

Born in Peshawar, Mulk Raj Anand was the son of Lala Chand Anand and Ishwar Kaur. Anand was educated in Amritsar before winning a scholarship that took him to England in 1925. Back home, Anand had taken part in the non-cooperation movement. Now in England, he worked with other nationalists to drum up support for Indian independence among the British public. In 1929, Anand completed a doctoral degree in philosophy, and subsequently worked as a lecturer. During his time in London, he was drawn to socialism and actively supported workers’ strikes. His experiences convinced him that the poor all over the world faced similar struggles, which could only be alleviated through fighting for equal rights and the ending of discriminatory practices like casteism.